ARCHITECTURE FOUNDATIONS AND HARAPPAN URBANISM

ARCHITECTURE READING METHOD → HARAPPAN CITY GRID → TWO-PART SETTLEMENT → BRICK-TO-AUTHORITY CHAIN → DRAINAGE AS A NETWORK → GREAT BATH EVIDENCE TEST

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 →

STAGE 00 ARCHITECTURE READING METHOD

ARCHITECTURE READING METHOD · BRICK, STONE, MORTAR AND FINISH · GRID, ZONING, CIRCULATION AND WATER · DOMESTIC, CIVIC, STORAGE OR RITUAL · EVIDENCE LIMIT · FORM IS NOT AN INSCRIPTION · MUST REMEMBER · HARAPPAN ARCHITECTURE JOINS RIGHT-ANGLED STREET GRIDS, CITADEL-LOWER-TOWN ZONING, STANDARDISED

CORE CLAIM
- MATERIAL → brick, stone, mortar and finish
- PLAN → grid, zoning, circulation and water

MECHANISM
- FUNCTION → domestic, civic, storage or ritual
- EVIDENCE LIMIT → form is not an inscription

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Harappan architecture joins right-angled street grids, citadel-lower-town zoning, standardised burnt brick, house-to-street
- drainage, wells, baths and regionally adapted water systems at sites such as Dholavira.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Harappan architecture joins right-angled street grids, citadel-lower-town zoning, standardised burnt brick, house-to-street drainage, wells, baths and regionally adapted water systems at sites such as Dholavira.

01 →

STAGE 01 HARAPPAN CITY GRID

HARAPPAN CITY GRID · NORTH-SOUTH STREET · PLANNED URBAN AXIS · EAST-WEST STREET · RIGHT-ANGLE CROSSING · HOUSES AND FACILITIES ORGANISED · PRE-PLANNING, NOT A NAMED RULER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NORTH-SOUTH STREET → planned urban axis	BLOCKS → houses and facilities organised	NORTH-SOUTH STREET → planned urban axis
EAST-WEST STREET → right-angle crossing	INFERENCE → pre-planning, not a named ruler	EAST-WEST STREET → right-angle crossing

CORE CLAIM
- NORTH-SOUTH STREET → planned urban axis
- EAST-WEST STREET → right-angle crossing

MECHANISM
- BLOCKS → houses and facilities organised
- INFERENCE → pre-planning, not a named ruler

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NORTH-SOUTH STREET → planned urban axis
- EAST-WEST STREET → right-angle crossing

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BLOCKS → houses and facilities organised; INFERENCE → pre-planning, not a named ruler.

02 →

STAGE 02 TWO-PART SETTLEMENT

TWO-PART SETTLEMENT · RAISED WESTERN PUBLIC ZONE · LOWER TOWN · LARGER RESIDENTIAL ZONE · HOUSE SIZE · DIFFERENTIATION IS VISIBLE · CASTE HIERARCHY IS NOT PROVED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CITADEL → raised western public zone	HOUSE SIZE → differentiation is visible	CITADEL → raised western public zone
LOWER TOWN → larger residential zone	CAUTION → caste hierarchy is not proved	LOWER TOWN → larger residential zone

CORE CLAIM
- CITADEL → raised western public zone
- LOWER TOWN → larger residential zone

MECHANISM
- HOUSE SIZE → differentiation is visible
- CAUTION → caste hierarchy is not proved

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CITADEL → raised western public zone
- LOWER TOWN → larger residential zone

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HOUSE SIZE → differentiation is visible; CAUTION → caste hierarchy is not proved.

03 →

STAGE 03 BRICK-TO-AUTHORITY CHAIN

BRICK-TO-AUTHORITY CHAIN · STANDARD BRICK · REPEATABLE CONSTRUCTION · GYPSUM MORTAR · JOINED LAYERED MASONRY · DISTANT SITES · SHARED TECHNICAL NORM · NO PROVEN CENTRALISED EMPIRE

STANDARD BRICK → repeatable construction → GYPSUM MORTAR → joined layered masonry → DISTANT SITES → shared technical norm → LIMIT → no proven centralised empire

CORE CLAIM
- STANDARD BRICK → repeatable construction
- GYPSUM MORTAR → joined layered masonry

MECHANISM
- DISTANT SITES → shared technical norm
- LIMIT → no proven centralised empire

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- STANDARD BRICK → repeatable construction
- GYPSUM MORTAR → joined layered masonry

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DISTANT SITES → shared technical norm; LIMIT → no proven centralised empire.

04 →

STAGE 04 DRAINAGE AS A NETWORK

DRAINAGE AS A NETWORK · SMALL HOUSEHOLD DRAIN · LARGER COVERED DRAIN · SEDIMENT CAPTURED · REMOVABLE COVER · REGULAR CLEANING POSSIBLE

BATHROOM → small household drain → STREET → larger covered drain → CESSPIT → sediment captured → REMOVABLE COVER → regular cleaning possible

CORE CLAIM
- BATHROOM → small household drain
- STREET → larger covered drain

MECHANISM
- CESSPIT → sediment captured
- REMOVABLE COVER → regular cleaning possible

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BATHROOM → small household drain
- STREET → larger covered drain

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CESSPIT → sediment captured; REMOVABLE COVER → regular cleaning possible.

05 →

STAGE 05 GREAT BATH EVIDENCE TEST

GREAT BATH EVIDENCE TEST · TANK WITH SURROUNDING ROOMS · DIRECT CLAIM · COLLECTIVE PUBLIC WATER STRUCTURE · CEREMONIAL OR RITUAL CLEANSING · NO INVENTED PRIESTHOOD OR RITE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FORM → tank with surrounding rooms	INFERENCE → ceremonial or ritual cleansing	FORM → tank with surrounding rooms
DIRECT CLAIM → collective public water structure	PROHIBITION → no invented priesthood or rite	DIRECT CLAIM → collective public water structure

CORE CLAIM
- FORM → tank with surrounding rooms
- DIRECT CLAIM → collective public water structure

MECHANISM
- INFERENCE → ceremonial or ritual cleansing
- PROHIBITION → no invented priesthood or rite

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- FORM → tank with surrounding rooms
- DIRECT CLAIM → collective public water structure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INFERENCE → ceremonial or ritual cleansing; PROHIBITION → no invented priesthood or rite.

06 →

STAGE 06 NAMING PUBLIC STRUCTURES

NAMING PUBLIC STRUCTURES · RAISED PLATFORM + AIR DUCTS · STORAGE LIKELY · MODERN LABEL · CONVENTIONALLY CALLED GRANARY · NO INSCRIPTION · FUNCTION REMAINS DEBATED · NOT SECURELY IDENTIFIED

RAISED PLATFORM + AIR DUCTS → storage likely

MODERN LABEL → conventionally called granary · NO INSCRIPTION → function remains debated · PALACE/TEMPLE → not securely identified

CORE CLAIM
- RAISED PLATFORM + AIR DUCTS → storage likely
- MODERN LABEL → conventionally called granary

MECHANISM
- NO INSCRIPTION → function remains debated
- PALACE/TEMPLE → not securely identified

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RAISED PLATFORM + AIR DUCTS → storage likely
- MODERN LABEL → conventionally called granary

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RAISED PLATFORM + AIR DUCTS → storage likely.

07 →

STAGE 07 REGIONAL URBAN SOLUTIONS

REGIONAL URBAN SOLUTIONS · GREAT BATH AND DRAINS · FORTIFICATIONS AND RESERVOIRS · DEBATED BASIN · DISTINCT LOCAL PLANS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
MOHENJO-DARO → Great Bath and drains	LOTHAL → debated basin	MOHENJO-DARO → Great Bath and drains
DHOLAVIRA → fortifications and reservoirs	KALIBANGAN/HARAPPA → distinct local plans	DHOLAVIRA → fortifications and reservoirs

CORE CLAIM
- MOHENJO-DARO → Great Bath and drains
- DHOLAVIRA → fortifications and reservoirs

MECHANISM
- LOTHAL → debated basin
- KALIBANGAN/HARAPPA → distinct local plans

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MOHENJO-DARO → Great Bath and drains
- DHOLAVIRA → fortifications and reservoirs

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LOTHAL → debated basin; KALIBANGAN/HARAPPA → distinct local plans.

08 →

STAGE 08 EVIDENCE LADDER

EVIDENCE LADDER · GRID, BRICK, DRAIN AND RESERVOIR · STORAGE AND FUNCTIONAL ZONING · PRECISE HIERARCHY AND AUTHORITY FORM · NAMED KING, TEMPLE OR STATE FAITH

STRONG → grid, brick, drain and reservoir

MODERATE → storage and functional zoning · WEAK → precise hierarchy and authority form · UNSUPPORTED → named king, temple or state faith

CORE CLAIM
- STRONG → grid, brick, drain and reservoir
- MODERATE → storage and functional zoning

MECHANISM
- WEAK → precise hierarchy and authority form
- UNSUPPORTED → named king, temple or state faith

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- STRONG → grid, brick, drain and reservoir
- MODERATE → storage and functional zoning

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: UNSUPPORTED → named king, temple or state faith.

09 →

STAGE 09 CIVIC AND MONUMENTAL CONTRAST

CIVIC AND MONUMENTAL CONTRAST · STREETS, WELLS, BATHS AND DRAINS · ROYAL-SACRED MONUMENTS · DIFFERENT VISIBLE INVESTMENT · PRESERVATION AND NAMING BIASES REMAIN · CLOSE DISTINCTION · THE GREAT BATH'S COLLECTIVE WATER FUNCTION IS SECURE BUT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
HARAPPAN → streets, wells, baths and drains	ANALYSIS → different visible investment	CLOSE DISTINCTION: The Great Bath's collective water function is secure but ritual cleansing is inferential
EGYPT/MESOPOTAMIA → royal-sacred monuments	QUALIFY → preservation and naming biases remain	'granary' and Lothal 'dockyard' are conventional or debated labels, while no palace or temple is securely identified.

CORE CLAIM
- HARAPPAN → streets, wells, baths and drains
- EGYPT/MESOPOTAMIA → royal-sacred monuments

MECHANISM
- ANALYSIS → different visible investment
- QUALIFY → preservation and naming biases remain

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: The Great Bath's collective water function is secure but ritual cleansing is inferential
- 'granary' and Lothal 'dockyard' are conventional or debated labels, while no palace or temple is securely identified.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: The Great Bath's collective water function is secure but ritual cleansing is inferential; 'granary' and Lothal 'dockyard' are conventional or debated labels, while no palace or temple is securely identified.

10 →

STAGE 10 WATER ARCHITECTURE FIREWALL

WATER ARCHITECTURE FIREWALL · SETTLEMENT SUPPLY AND SANITATION · ARID STORAGE AND PATRONAGE · TEMPLE TANK · RITUAL AND PROCESSIONAL SPACE · SHARED WATER DOES NOT PROVE DESCENT · EVIDENCE LIMIT · STANDARDISATION SUPPORTS COORDINATION OR A SHARED TECHNICAL CULTURE, NOT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
HARAPPAN → settlement supply and sanitation	TEMPLE TANK → ritual and processional space	EVIDENCE LIMIT: Standardisation supports coordination or a shared technical culture, not proof of one
STEPWELL → arid storage and patronage	RULE → shared water does not prove descent	centralised empire, caste zoning, named rulers or religious institutions while the script remains undeciphered.

CORE CLAIM
- HARAPPAN → settlement supply and sanitation
- STEPWELL → arid storage and patronage

MECHANISM
- TEMPLE TANK → ritual and processional space
- RULE → shared water does not prove descent

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Standardisation supports coordination or a shared technical culture, not proof of one
- centralised empire, caste zoning, named rulers or religious institutions while the script remains undeciphered.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → shared water does not prove descent.

11 →

STAGE 11 HARAPPAN ANSWER SPINE

HARAPPAN ANSWER SPINE · CIVIC URBANISM THESIS · GRID, ZONING, DRAINAGE AND BRICK · DHOLAVIRA, LOTHAL AND MONUMENTALITY · NO CONFIRMED PALACE OR TEMPLE

OPEN → civic urbanism thesis → BODY → grid, zoning, drainage and brick → COMPARE → Dholavira, Lothal and monumentality → CLOSE → no confirmed palace or temple

CORE CLAIM
- OPEN → civic urbanism thesis
- BODY → grid, zoning, drainage and brick

MECHANISM
- COMPARE → Dholavira, Lothal and monumentality
- CLOSE → no confirmed palace or temple

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- OPEN → civic urbanism thesis
- BODY → grid, zoning, drainage and brick

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPARE → Dholavira, Lothal and monumentality; CLOSE → no confirmed palace or temple.

E →

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · NO BOOK-PERIOD CLAIM IN THIS TOPIC REQUIRES URGENT CURRENT · TREATING 'MIGHT HAVE BEEN THE RESIDENCE OF RULERS AND · ASSERTING A SPECIFIC POLITICAL STRUCTURE (E.G. "A CENTRALISED HARAPPAN · TREATING THE ABSENCE OF TEMPLES/PALACES AS EVIDENCE OF AN · CONVERTING CONVENTIONAL ARCHAEOLOGICAL NAMES INTO PROVEN FUNCTIONS. · READING THE SO-CALLED PASHUPATI SEAL AS DEFINITIVE PROOF OF · ANCIENT HISTORY OWNS IVC CHRONOLOGY, DECLINE THEORIES, THE SCRIPT

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- No book-period claim in this topic requires urgent current
- NOT: Treating "might have been the residence of rulers and aristocrats"
- NOT: Asserting a specific political structure (e.g. "a centralised Harappan
- NOT: Treating the absence of temples/palaces as evidence of an areligious

ADVANCED DEBATE
- NOT: Converting conventional archaeological names into proven functions.
- NOT: Reading the so-called Pashupati seal as definitive proof of Shiva.
- NOT: Ancient History owns IVC chronology, decline theories, the script
- NOT: Science & Technology or Geography would own any question on

LEGACY / NUANCE
- This file's evidentiary-caution method (Section 4) is reused whenever
- 00 Master-Framework.md Sections 4-5 — the evidence hierarchy and
- CAUTION: Downstream topics: Topic 02 extends the architecture timeline;
- Verified against Nitin — .pdf , PDF pp. 30-40 directly.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels